11-30 第1篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Saturday Dad and I Fixed the Dripping Tap

① Our kitchen tap had been dripping for eleven days. Not a big drip — just the quiet, lonely *tick, tick, tick* that sounds like a small clock in the middle of the night. Mum had noticed it on Tuesday of the week before. Dad said, "Next Saturday, Ming and I will fix it." On the night before, at the dinner table, Dad turned to me and said, **"Ming, tomorrow you are my small assistant. Wake up at 09:00, wash, breakfast, and be ready by 09:45."** He said it the way he sometimes talks about a patient at the hospital: serious, warm, and with a small amount of careful respect that I had not heard him use with me before.

② Saturday morning, at 09:45, I was ready. I had put on an old dark T-shirt and a pair of old jeans, because Dad had told me once that "serious small jobs deserve old clothes." He came into the kitchen carrying a small black toolbox, a flashlight, a plastic tray, two soft rags, and a roll of white thread. He set the toolbox on the floor and said, **"Before we touch anything, we draw a small plan on paper."** I was surprised. I had expected a wrench first. He said, "A plan, Ming, is always first. Especially when water is involved."

③ We sat on the kitchen floor. He drew, in pencil, a **simple four-step map** on a scrap of paper: **(1)** turn off the main water valve under the sink; **(2)** open the tap until no more water comes out; **(3)** unscrew the handle; replace the tiny rubber seal inside; **(4)** screw the handle back on, turn the valve on slowly, check for any drip. He asked me to **read each step aloud**. I did. He said, "Good. Now we know what we are about to do. Most small mistakes happen not because the hand is slow, but because the head has not chosen a step." I nodded. I wrote the four steps in my own small notebook, carefully, in capital letters.

④ Dad turned off the valve. The tap gave one last small hiss and then a long, surprised silence. We opened the tap; a few drops fell; then nothing. Dad let me unscrew the small silver cap on the top of the handle with a **flat screwdriver**. "Gently, Ming. This is brass. Brass listens to soft pressure." Inside, a long brass screw held the handle in place. I used the small cross-head screwdriver to loosen it, turning it **anti-clockwise, slowly**, counting the turns in my head. After eight turns, the handle came free. Inside, at the bottom of the small metal house, sat the tiny piece we were looking for: a small **black rubber seal** called a **washer**, worn at one edge, rounded where it should have been flat.

⑤ Dad said, "This is the guilty one." He passed me the small plastic bag with a new washer. "Place it exactly the way the old one was sitting." I looked closely. The new washer was smooth and perfectly round. My hands felt **a little shaky**. Dad noticed. He

did not laugh or say "Don't worry." He simply said, "Ming, take a breath between picking it up and placing it. Breathe in, place, breathe out. Plumbers breathe at the right time." I took one slow breath. I placed the washer. It fell in evenly. The small ring of brass closed softly over it, as if the tap itself was sighing with relief.

⑥ I screwed the brass screw back, clockwise, slowly. I used the flat screwdriver to press the silver cap back into place. Dad opened the main valve under the sink, not all the way — just **a quarter turn at first**, "in case we missed a small thing." We watched the tap's nose for seven long seconds. No drop. He opened the valve another quarter turn. Still no drop. Finally, full. We turned the tap itself on; a clear, happy jet of water fell into the sink, sparkled, and disappeared down the drain.

⑦ We stood for a moment, looking at the tap the way you look at a friend who has just returned from a long trip. Then Dad did something small and serious. He asked me to **wipe the tap dry and to write the date of the repair** on a small white sticker, stuck to the inside of the cabinet below the sink. *"Repair 1. 30 Nov 2027. Washer replaced. Next check in one year. Done by Dad + Ming."* I asked why we were writing it. Dad said, *"Because the next adult who opens this cabinet, one year from now, should not have to guess. Small honest notes are what houses are made of."*

⑧ We cleaned up together. Dad let me carry the light toolbox back to the shoe-cabinet shelf. He did not thank me loudly or take a photo. The only thing he said, as we stood at the kitchen sink washing our hands side by side, was, **"Ming, you saw today how a calm head and small breath help a small job go well. Remember this morning the next time you open a maths paper you are afraid of. The paper, the tap, and you — there is always a small four-step plan."** I laughed quietly. I did not know, until he said it, that a tap could also teach maths.

⑨ Late that afternoon, I went back into the kitchen alone. The tap was perfectly dry. I opened it, just to hear the water fall; I turned it off, just to hear the silence. No drop. I felt, for the first time, that part of our home — the small silver nose of this one tap — had, briefly, belonged to my hands. I wrote three lines in my diary that evening: *"Dad drew a plan. I followed. The tap listens to soft pressure. Small honest notes are what houses are made of."* I closed the book. I understood that growing up is sometimes **a quiet Saturday morning with a small screwdriver, an old T-shirt, and a four-step plan**. The rest of the day was ordinary. But I was not quite ordinary anymore.

注释： tap 水龙头；wrench 扳手；valve 阀门；washer 垫圈；screwdriver 螺丝刀

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What did Dad do BEFORE he or the writer touched the tap?

A. He sent the writer to the shop to buy parts.
B. He said, "Before we touch anything, we draw a small plan on paper" — they sat on the kitchen floor and together drew a pencil four-step map (turn off the main valve; open the tap until no water comes; unscrew the handle and replace the rubber seal; screw the handle back, open the valve slowly, check for any drip) and read each step aloud.
C. He called a plumber first.
D. He took a photo of the tap.

2. Why did Dad tell the writer "serious small jobs deserve old clothes"?

A. Because new clothes were in the laundry.
B. Because the writer had no new clothes.
C. To teach a small serious attitude toward careful manual work; Dad used the same warm-and-serious voice he used at the hospital, showing respect and preparation for the job.
D. Because it was a rainy day.

3. What did Dad say about the writer's shaky hands when placing the new washer?

A. "Don't be afraid."
B. "Take a breath between picking it up and placing it. Breathe in, place, breathe out. Plumbers breathe at the right time."
C. "Let me do it for you."
D. "We will stop here."

4. Why did Dad ask the writer to write the date of the repair on a small white sticker inside the cabinet?

A. Because Mum would want to see it.
B. Because the next adult who opens the cabinet, a year later, should not have to guess — "small honest notes are what houses are made of."
C. Because the school teacher had asked for a report.
D. Because the tap needed a decoration.

5. What is the writer's main realisation at the end of the passage?

A. That growing up is loud and sudden.
B. That fixing taps is a family business.
C. That growing up is sometimes a quiet Saturday morning with a small screwdriver, an old T-shirt, and a four-step plan — a calm head and small breath help a small job go well, and the same careful approach can be used when facing a maths paper.
D. That small repairs are useless.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②—③段"先画计划"
【解析】四步计划 + 朗读直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第②段"旧衣"与语气
【解析】严肃态度主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段父亲的话
【解析】"呼吸 + 放"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑦段小白贴纸
【解析】"Small honest notes are what houses are made of"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑨段结尾
【解析】"周六 + 计划 + 呼吸 = 成长"主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。